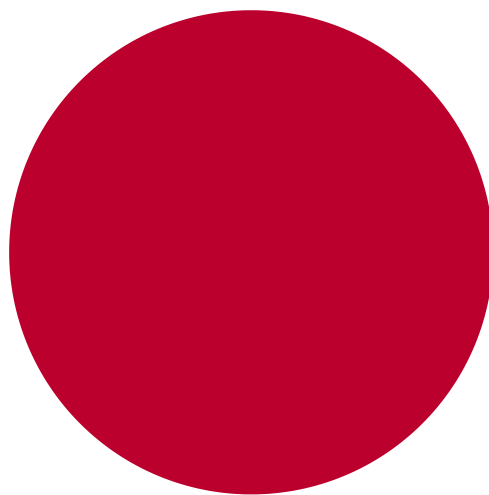




THE TOKYO-BASED GUIDE SERIES

JAPAN TRAVEL PLANNER

日本旅行プランナー



ITINERARY · BUDGET · CHECKLISTS · LOCAL TOKYO TIPS
MADE IN SHINJUKU, TOKYO — UPDATED FOR 2026

Trip Overview

旅の概要

THE BASICS

Travelers

Dates

Cities

Trip budget

Countdown

FLIGHTS

Outbound

Return

Airport → hotel

Booking refs

ACCOMMODATION

Stay 1

Stay 2

Stay 3

Check-in notes

Local tip: Tokyo hotels rarely allow check-in before 15:00, but nearly all hold luggage for free from the morning — drop your bags and start exploring. Airport limousine buses and “takkyubin” luggage forwarding (about ¥2,000–2,600 per bag) can also send suitcases ahead to your next city.

Pre-Trip Checklist 出発前の準備

8-4 WEEKS OUT

- ☐ Passport valid for entire stay
- ☐ Book flights & first hotels
- ☐ Check visa / visa-waiver rules for your country
- ☐ Reserve big-ticket sights (Ghibli Museum, teamLab, Shibuya Sky sell out weeks ahead)
- ☐ Compare a JR Pass vs. single tickets — it only pays off with 2+ long shinkansen legs

2-1 WEEKS OUT

- ☐ Fill in Visit Japan Web (immigration & customs QR)
- ☐ Buy an eSIM or pocket Wi-Fi
- ☐ Travel insurance
- ☐ Notify your bank / enable overseas card use

MONEY & APPS

- ☐ Add Suica/PASMO to Apple Pay or plan a Welcome Suica card
- ☐ Plan cash: Japan is card-friendly now, but small restaurants, shrines and markets still want yen
- ☐ Download: Google Maps, Google Translate (offline JP), Japan Travel by Navitime
- ☐ Note your country's embassy address

Local tip: 7-Eleven ATMs accept nearly every foreign card, are everywhere, and have English menus — there is no need to exchange large amounts at the airport. Convenience stores are also where you'll buy transit-friendly breakfasts for ¥300-500.

Budget Planner 予算管理

CATEGORY	PLANNED (¥)	ACTUAL (¥)	NOTES
Flights			
Accommodation			
Transport (IC card, trains, shinkansen)			
Food & drink			
Sights & experiences			
Shopping & souvenirs			
Connectivity (eSIM / Wi-Fi)			
Buffer (10-15%)			
Total			

REALISTIC DAILY COSTS (PER PERSON, TOKYO)

Budget day (conbini + ramen + free sights) ¥6,000-9,000

Mid-range day (restaurants + paid sights) ¥12,000-20,000

Splurge day (sushi counter, Shibuya Sky...) ¥25,000+

Metro day of hopping around Tokyo ≈ ¥800-1,200

Local tip: Lunch is Tokyo’s best deal — the same restaurant that charges ¥6,000 at dinner often serves a ¥1,200-1,800 lunch set (定食). Plan your “nice meals” at noon and eat casual at night to cut food costs almost in half.

Daily Itinerary

1日の計画

Day / Date		Weather
TIME	PLAN	TRANSIT / NOTES
Morning		
Lunch		
Afternoon		
Dinner		
Evening		
SPENT TODAY		BEST MOMENT OF THE DAY

Tokyo: A First-Timer's 3 Days

東京3日間モデルコース

A realistic pace — two neighborhoods per day, not seven. Written and walk-tested by a Tokyo local based in Shinjuku.

DAY 1	WEST TOKYO — SHINJUKU & SHIBUYA
AM	Shinjuku Gyoen at 09:00 opening (¥500, calm before crowds) → walk to the Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building free observatory (202 m, no ticket needed)
PM	Meiji Shrine & Harajuku → Shibuya: the Scramble from street level first, then Hachiko. Book Shibuya Sky for sunset weeks ahead — or skip it and keep your yen
Night	Back to Shinjuku: Omoide Yokocho's lantern alleys for yakitori, then a stroll through neon Kabukicho (look, don't follow touts)
DAY 2	EAST TOKYO — ASAKUSA, UENO & AKIHABARA
AM	Senso-ji before 09:00 (the difference in crowds is night and day) → Nakamise snacks → Sumida River terrace views of Tokyo Skytree
PM	Ueno Park & one museum (Tokyo National Museum if you pick just one) → Ameyoko market street → Akihabara arcades and retro-game floors
Night	Izakaya dinner under the Yurakucho railway arches — order by pointing, everyone does
DAY 3	BAY SIDE — TSUKIJI, GINZA & TEAMLAB
AM	Tsukiji Outer Market breakfast (go hungry: tamagoyaki, tuna bowls, oysters) → Hamarikyu Gardens tea house
PM	Ginza — depachika food halls in the basements are free to wander and unforgettable → teamLab Planets (buy tickets online, timed entry)
Night	Tokyo Station's Ramen Street, then the Marunouchi red-brick station facade lit up — a quiet, perfect last photo

Day Trips from Tokyo

東京発・日帰り旅

All reachable from Shinjuku or Tokyo Station without a JR Pass. Times are one-way.

WHERE	FROM / TIME	APPROX. COST	WHY GO / LOCAL NOTES
Hakone	Shinjuku · 85 min	¥6,100 Free-pass	Onsen, ropeway over volcanic steam, Lake Ashi. The Hakone Freepass covers the whole loop — do it counter-clockwise to beat tour groups
Kamakura	Tokyo Stn · 60 min	≈ ¥1,900 return	Great Buddha, hydrangea temples, Enoden seaside tram. Go on a weekday; weekends are packed by 11:00
Nikko	Asakusa · 110 min	≈ ¥5,700 pass	Toshogu Shrine’s carved gates and cedar forests. Autumn color peaks late Oct-early Nov
Kawagoe	Shinjuku · 55 min	≈ ¥1,000 return	“Little Edo” clay-walled merchant street, sweet-potato everything, kimono rental town
Mt. Takao	Shinjuku · 50 min	≈ ¥800 return	Tokyo’s easiest mountain — cable car, monkey park, Fuji views on clear winter mornings
Yokohama	Shibuya · 30 min	≈ ¥600 return	Ramen Museum, Chinatown, harbor night views from the Cosmo Clock ferris wheel

Local tip: For Hakone and Kawagoe, buy the private-railway “free pass” at Shinjuku’s Odakyu or Seibu counters — they bundle the round trip with unlimited local buses and small discounts, and staff speak English. Check typhoon forecasts in September; mountain ropeways stop in high wind.

Essential Phrases

基本フレーズ

ENGLISH	SAY IT (ROMAJI)	JAPANESE
Hello	kon-nichiwa	こんにちは
Thank you	arigatou gozaimasu	ありがとうございます
Excuse me / sorry	sumimasen	すみません
Yes / No	hai / iie	はい / いいえ
How much is it?	ikura desu ka?	いくらですか？
This one, please	kore o kudasai	これをください
Where is ...?	... wa doko desu ka?	～はどこですか？
The check, please	o-kaikei onegaishimasu	お会計お願いします
Do you speak English?	eigo o hanasemasu ka?	英語を話せますか？
It's delicious!	oishii!	おいしい！
Cheers!	kanpai!	乾杯！
I'd like to go to ~ (taxi)	~ made onegaishimasu	～までお願いします

Local tip: “Sumimasen” is the single most useful word in Japan — it opens conversations, calls waiters (say it clearly, waving is fine), and apologizes for bumping someone, all at once. Nobody expects perfect Japanese; the attempt is what's appreciated.

Japan Food Bucket List 食べたいもののリスト

THE CLASSICS

- ☐ Counter sushi (lunch sets are the smart splurge)
- ☐ Ramen — try two styles: shoyu & tonkotsu
- ☐ Tempura over rice (tendon)
- ☐ Wagyu — yakiniku or a steak lunch
- ☐ Izakaya night: yakitori + a lemon sour
- ☐ Okonomiyaki or monjayaki (Tokyo's own)
- ☐ Proper matcha & wagashi in a garden tea house

CHEAP & UNMISSABLE

- ☐ Conbini breakfast: onigiri + egg sando
- ☐ Standing soba at a train station (¥400)
- ☐ Depachika food hall grazing
- ☐ Taiyaki or melonpan, eaten warm
- ☐ Vending-machine hot corn soup (winter)
- ☐ Strawberry daifuku from a street stall
- ☐ A ¥120 seasonal KitKat you can't get home

Local tip: Lines in Japan usually mean “worth it,” but for ramen a 15-minute queue at 11:20 becomes 45 minutes by noon — eat lunch early (11:00–11:30) or late (14:00) and you will almost never wait.

Packing List

持ち物リスト

DOCUMENTS & MONEY

- ☐ Passport (+ photo of it in your phone)
- ☐ Visit Japan Web QR screenshot
- ☐ Two credit/debit cards, kept separately
- ☐ Coin purse — you will collect coins fast

TECH

- ☐ eSIM installed / pocket Wi-Fi booked
- ☐ Power bank (long train days)
- ☐ Plug type A adapter (100V, same as US shape)

JAPAN-SPECIFIC SMART PACKS

- ☐ Slip-on shoes — you'll remove them at temples, some restaurants & fitting rooms
- ☐ Small hand towel (many restrooms have no dryers)
- ☐ Foldable bag for trash — public bins are rare, you carry it until a combini
- ☐ Comfortable socks without holes (see: shoe removal)
- ☐ Half-empty suitcase — you will fill it
- ☐ Layers: Tokyo swings 10°C+ between morning and afternoon in spring/autumn

Notes & Memories メモと思い出

[illegible]

This planner was made in Shinjuku, Tokyo, and is updated as the city changes. Questions, corrections, or a tip of your own? We'd love to hear how your trip went. よい旅を！ — have a wonderful journey.